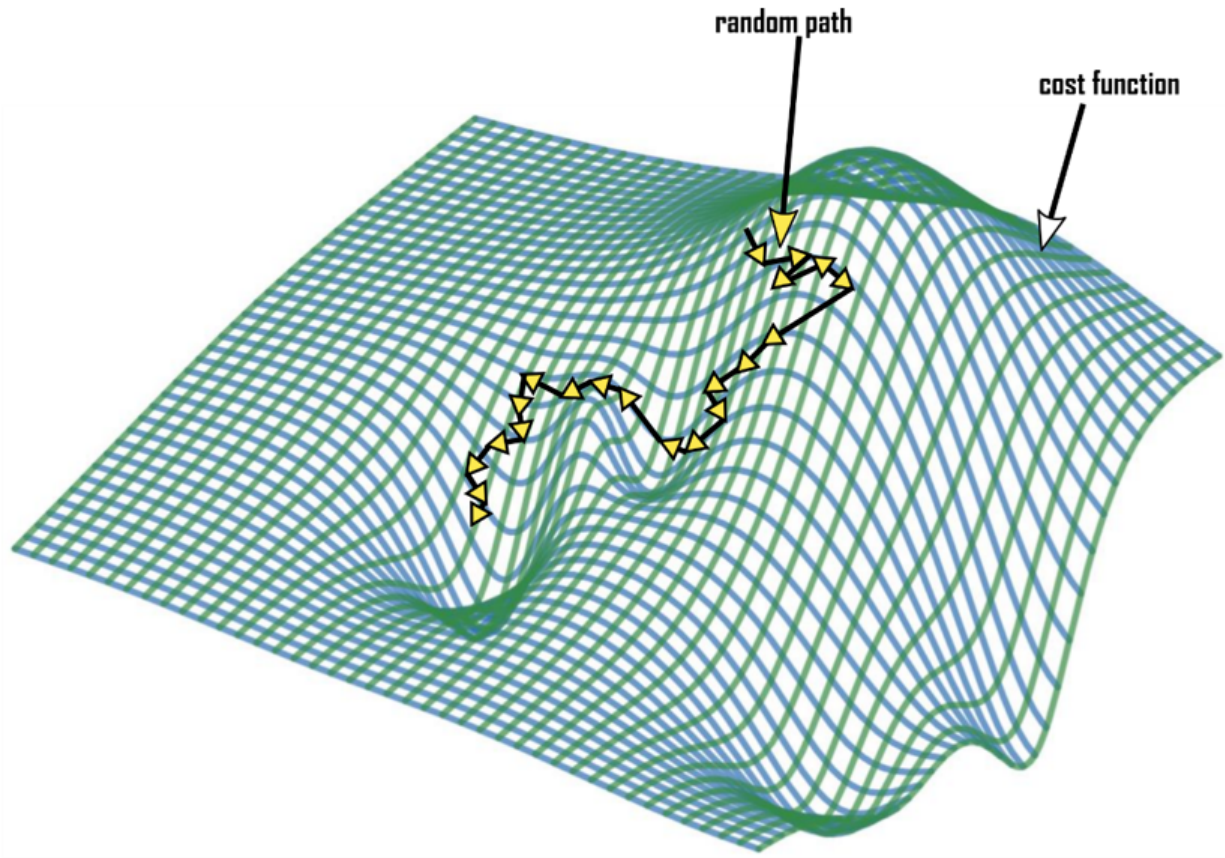


Figure 17.4 The ups and downs of a possible path followed by simulated annealing optimization. Be warned, this is an artificial example, in real runs, likely, in the initial phases the algorithm would move all over the place, while later, when temperature drops, it will converge towards one of the minima.

The algorithm, in real applications, is more likely to initially jump back and forth, exploring several areas of the landscape, and often moving uphill. Then as cooling progresses, it will be less likely to transition to higher positions, and at the same time we can directly or indirectly reduce the length of the random steps; overall, after the initial exploration phase, it should enter a fine-tuning phase.